

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

THIS IS HOW YOU DO IT

At the recently concluded Congress plenary in Raipur, a nearly 2 km stretch of the road was laid with red rose petals to welcome Congress general secretary Priyanka Gandhi-Vadra. When she rose to speak on the final day, she received the loudest cheer. What explains the younger Gandhi sibling's popularity among Congress workers? She began her speech by taking the names of grassroots workers who had carried the party flag on the Bharat Jodo Yatra, and paid condolences to some others who did not feature in the list of top leaders who had passed away between 2018 and 2022 that Mukul Wasnik read out. She also said that while her family members were just grilled by the ED, Congress workers had faced police batons and even gone to jail. There couldn't be a better example for her junior colleagues on how to enthuse others, particularly the voter.

UNDERGROUND SAFE



ANI

Where should one keep their money? If you ask Jharkhand chief minister **Hemant Soren**, he will tell you that it is best to wrap it in a plastic bag and bury it underground, since banks are unable to do their jobs these days. Though Soren intended it as a dig at the Narendra Modi-led government's 'failure' to manage the economy, his statement during the campaign for an assembly bypoll on February 22 is being touted as an example of a constitutional position-holder going overboard. His detractors want to know if he hides his money underground.

Too Close for Comfort

MLC and UP Haj Committee chairman **Mohsin Raza**'s desire to showcase his proximity to Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath has become embarrassing for the government. On February 22, when the CM was posing for a photo in front of the media just before the budget was presented, Raza pushed aside two senior ministers to stand right next to Adityanath. He even flashed the victory sign, all the while grinning broadly. Earlier, during the Republic Day celebrations, Raza occupied the seat reserved for a minister just to be seen next to the CM. Social media has been unforgiving of his *chamchagiri*, trolling him mercilessly for both trespasses.



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

Kaushik Deka with Jumana Shah, Ashish Misra, Romita Datta and Amitabh Srivastava



Plane Misuse

The removal of high-profile officer **Captain Ajay Chauhan** as director of Civil Aviation and CEO of Gujarat State Aviation Infrastructure Company Ltd (GUJSAIL) has set tongues wagging. He was allegedly misusing aircraft designated for the chief minister and the governor for personal leisure trips. Chauhan is reportedly said to have made around a hundred trips at the exchequer's expense in the past nine years, though he denies it. But no one holding two powerful positions in the aviation department for over a decade could have possibly done this without support from others. Will more big heads roll?



Dribble Trouble

Senior Trinamool Congress leader and spokesperson **Kunal Ghosh** has been dodging and dribbling reporters' queries for some years now with professional skill. One would have thought he'd have no trouble taking them on at the friendly football match for the Reporters' Cup. It turns out he fractured his leg after being badly cornered. Ghosh had been a journalist of repute before he joined the Trinamool. While he did well as a journalist and politician, he does not seem to be having much luck with Khela Hobe on the ground.